The Pure Vajra Lamp: A Concise Explanation of the Hevajra Sādhana

Hevajrasādhanasya Vajrapradīpa nāma Ṭipiṇī Śuddha · Toh 1237 · Derge Tengyur
ཀྱེ་རྡོ་རྗེ་སྒྲུབ་ཐབས་ཀྱི་རྒྱུད་དོ་བའཛྲ་པ་དག་པ་རྡོ་རྗེ་སྙིང་པོ་ཞེས་བྱ་བ།

The Pure Vajra Lamp, a Concise Explanation of the Hevajra Sādhana, known in Sanskrit as the Hevajrasādhanasya Vajrapradīpa nāma Ṭippaṇī Śuddha and in Tibetan as Kye Dorjé Drubtap kyi Dordu Shepa Dakpa Dorjé Drönma, is Toh 1237 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the commentaries on the tantras. It is a commentary attributed to the accomplished master Jālandharipa on the Hevajra sādhana composed by Saroruhapāda, a practice text for meditating on Hevajra and his retinue of goddesses. Working through the sādhana's summary topics, it explains the generation stage step by step, including the circle of protection, the charnel grounds and celestial palace, the generation of the deities, empowerment, mantra recitation, the torma offering and the yogin's daily conduct, and it reads these ritual steps in terms of the completion stage, showing how each element is purified into emptiness, luminosity and coemergent bliss. The work closes with a colophon stating that it was translated into Tibetan by Nyima Gyaltsen Palsangpo on the basis of the teaching of the paṇḍita Mañjuśrī.

In the language of India: he vajra sādhanasya vajra pradīpa nāma ṭipiṇī śuddha. In the language of Tibet: A Concise Explanation of the Hevajra Sādhana, called The Pure Vajra Lamp.

Homage to glorious Hevajra.

I bow at the feet of Hevajra,
Whose nature is free of conceptual thought.
Relying on the generation stage,
I shall clearly explain its purification.

First of all, I shall state the summary topics of the sādhana. They are: then, the circle of offering; the four abodes of Brahmā; the supreme and the coemergent; one's own chosen deity; the circle of protection; intense conviction in emptiness; the charnel grounds; the celestial palace; the causal maṇḍala; generation through melting; rousing; placing; the nature of aversion; emanating; the circle of wisdom; empowerment; sealing; tasting the nectar; the benefit of beings; the six limbs; clear light; rising; mantra recitation; the reality of the torma; the subtle yoga; the two armors; the two placings;

walking; food; conduct; sleeping; and rising again. Through these thirty-two summary topics of the sādhana, the marks of a great being are purified.

"First of all, the yogin who has an intelligence devoted to the welfare of sentient beings": "first" means at the very beginning. Whoever desires union (yoga) is a yogin. Whoever wishes to fulfill the hopes in the minds of sentient beings is to be understood as one who has an intelligence devoted to the welfare of sentient beings.

"Having pleased the venerable true guru, and having fully entered, in accordance with the rite, the maṇḍala taught in glorious Hevajra": he, having come to abide wholly in single-minded devotion and having completely cast aside cherishing of his own body, should please the guru, since the guru is pleased by a sincere mind. The one who knows the oral instructions of the true guru's advice is also the venerable true guru. When he has been pleased, so that they may admit him in accordance with the rite into the maṇḍala taught in Hevajra, it says, "having fully entered the maṇḍala taught in glorious Hevajra."

"Having been empowered in due order" means having been empowered in sequence, from the water empowerment and the rest up to its culmination in the conferral of the wisdom-gnosis empowerment.

"Through proper authorization": after the empowerment, the tantra is taught by setting forth the instructions as they were given. Having recognized that it benefits the disciple and that he is thereafter a fit vessel, the master should then make clear the reality of the culmination of supreme joy, of the joy of cessation and so forth, and should teach it by rendering the meaning of the words in another way. This is "through proper authorization." After that, the mantrin who has been properly authorized should practice, by that permission, the stages that will be explained, until he has obtained the mudrā.

"Having obtained the mudrā" means having obtained it to some degree.

"And having obtained the gnosis of reality, utterly pure and unerring": it is unerring because it is not mistaken. Moreover, having set aside the purity of this body as it is by nature, one knows by way of the gnosis of the utterly pure reality; hence it is gnosis, and one obtains the path of gnosis. This is "having obtained the gnosis of reality, utterly pure and unerring."

"And having obtained the signs": these are signs of an examined kind, because one has fully obtained the gnosis of reality, utterly pure and unerring.

Therefore the cause is the gnosis of unerring reality, and the result is the gnosis of unerring reality. Knowing its signs in accordance with the instructions, this is "having obtained the signs." Therefore it is said:

By the waterbirds one knows there is water,
And by the smoke one knows there is fire;
The wise bodhisattva
Comes to know by the signs.

From the syllable "and," moreover, it is meant that the yogin endowed with gnosis who wishes to accomplish glorious Hevajra, once he has obtained the consort spoken of in the root tantra, should go to a charnel ground or a forest.

After that, the yogin dwelling in a pleasing place such as a charnel ground should, in secret, make the torma and offerings that will be explained, invite the circle of offering by the rite as it was taught, worship it with the special offerings that are outer, secret and of reality, and then begin the meditation. Here, worship with the various goddesses such as the flower goddess is outer; meditating on the substances that are symbols of the pledge, held in the hands of the goddesses abiding in that circle, is secret; and the emanating and gathering of the body is called reality. By this, one should properly worship that venerable one together with his circle, invited by the nets of light rays issuing from the seed syllable abiding upon a sun at one's own heart. This makes clear the meaning of "arising from what abides upon the sun at one's own heart."

Then, in his presence, one should perform the sevenfold unsurpassed worship. Through these the Blessed One taught the circle of offering for the sake of the accumulation of merit: from the accumulation of merit comes the accumulation of wisdom, and from the accumulation of wisdom, unsurpassed awakening.

Then, having constantly generated great loving-kindness toward all sentient beings, with the character of a parent's love for an only child, one beholds them fallen into the ocean of saṃsāra. Just as one is distraught when one's child suffers in a prison, so one regards with great compassion the sentient beings who are without refuge. After that, the yogin who has obtained great joy, knowing that it is accomplished for himself as well, rejoices: the mantrin endowed with joy should cultivate joy. And he should cultivate great equanimity, characterized by freedom from all concern for gain, honor and the like, things of a self-important nature attached to saṃsāra.

The mantrin who has become thus should begin the supreme accomplishment:

Knowing it as the very nature of the sphere of reality,
First one meditates on a corpse;
And the yogin, abiding
Upon it, meditates on Heruka himself.

śrī heruka vajra. Abiding there, one should make manifest the meaning of the six syllables. Then, from the holy instructions, one should make manifest the meaning of the four syllables "śrī heruka" through the yoga of the samādhi of the vajra of gnosis-light, and one should meditate on it. This is the supreme.

This is the beginning of the coemergent yoga, having discarded the impure body. In an instant, in the center of the celestial palace of the buddhas, made clear by the syllables e vaṃ, with face, emblems and so forth as before, one should meditate on oneself as Vajrasattva, greatly peaceful, with a crown of matted locks, in the vajra posture, marked by the Dharma mudrā, two-armed, seated on a moon upon a corpse. And one should imagine the coemergent Heruka, who holds within him infinite world systems, bearing the thirty-two major marks and adorned with the eighty minor marks. So it is said.

Why is this? Because it says, "Joined in equality by the vowels and consonants (āli and kāli), the supreme state without intrinsic nature." This means that "corpse" carries the sense of the supreme: it is the seat of Vajrasattva. Its generation does not call for the syllables hūṃ phaṭ. As with the syllable "and" above, "syllable" here means emptiness. Therefore, where there are syllables, the generation proceeds by way of the stages of realization and so becomes a mass; hence the words "the mass generated from syllables." In that very tantra on which this relies, in the eighth chapter, the Blessed One said:

The union of the vowels and consonants
Is the seat of Vajrasattva;
For the mass that arises from syllables,
The syllables hūṃ phaṭ are not wanted.

As before, with faces, hand emblems and so forth, from the words "the jewel-light beautiful as the moon," indicated by the word "imagining," one visualizes the coemergent protector and then should begin the state of Dveṣavajra (the Vajra of Aversion).

Then, proclaiming the state of Dveṣavajra, one meditates on a sun from the letter ra, and by applying the unchanging syllable hūṃ one imagines it at his

heart. With its drop, one should imagine the moon as full. Abiding at its center is the syllable hūṃ, which makes clear the seed from which beings are born. Thus one meditates on him as the lord of the three realms of existence. "At his heart" means at the heart of Vajrasattva. This is the sequence taught in the chapter on the deity:

At one's own heart meditate on the letter ra;
From it arises a disc of the sun;
On it, the very form of hūṃ,
Whose nature is wisdom and method.
From the syllable hūṃ arises a vajra,
Black in color, greatly terrible;
Abiding at the center of the vajra's hub,
Meditate once more on the reality of hūṃ.
Seeing the syllable hūṃ fully transformed,

one meditates on the nature of aversion. By the phrase "the syllable hūṃ fully transformed," all of that is fully transformed and meditated upon at the heart of Dveṣavajra, and according to the instructions the vajra-holder becomes of the nature of Dveṣavajra. By the stages that will be explained, one should imagine a bodily shape equal to that one. In the center of the four, the yogin, according to his inclination and according to the instructions he has received, should meditate on such a greatly terrible lord, having the form of the three aspects of the chosen deity, with eight faces and so forth. This follows from the words, "Arisen perfectly from the body of the being, meditate on the lord of the maṇḍala."

Thus, through the yoga of Dveṣavajra, one should emanate the host of wrathful ones in due order into the directions and intermediate directions. Transformed from the syllable hūṃ, all of them blazing with great light rays, one sends forth these turbulent ones. Then in the eastern and the other directions one should visualize in order Yamāntaka, Prajñāntaka, Padmāntaka and Vighnāntaka. They are black, white, red and blue. They hold, respectively, a vajra hammer, a white vajra staff, a red vajra lotus and a vajra with open prongs. They are short and potbellied, and their heads are marked by Vairocana, the Lord of Jewels, Vajradharma and Amoghasiddhi.

Then, in the intermediate directions beginning with that of Īśāna, are Acala, Ṭakkirāja, Nīladaṇḍa and Mahābala. They are deep black and hold a sword, a hook, a staff and a trident. Ṭakkirāja and Acala are playful and adorned with

divine ornaments. Nīladaṇḍa and Mahābala are transformed in the manner of Yamāntaka. One visualizes them in its center. Furthermore, above is Uṣṇīṣacakravartin, yellow, holding a yellow wheel, with a crown ornament of Vairocana, short and potbellied. Below is Sumbharāja, black in color, holding a pestle, with a hanging belly. The four beginning with Ṭakkirāja, and Sumbharāja, have a crown ornament of Akṣobhya. These ten wrathful ones all stand with the left leg extended, and in the left hand they hold the threatening gesture and a vajra noose. They should be seen standing upon variegated lotuses and suns.

Having thus issued forth in due order, one visualizes the wrathful ones as having gone each to his own place. They abide facing him with palms joined, and one should see them, after first praising him with eight-line verses and with the heart and near-heart mantras, say, "What shall we do?"

Then, according to the divisions of pacifying and the rest, one gives them the command with oṃ sumbhani sumbha and so forth. They, endowed with understanding, take up the command of the vajra-holder, place their own emanations in their own places, bind the hosts of obstructors at the neck with vajra nooses, terrify them with their own weapons, seize them and come back. Having handed the hosts of obstructors over to their own emanations in the ten directions, one sees them abiding directly before the vajra-holder.

Here the host of obstructors is as follows. Indra is white, thousand-eyed, wearing a jewel crown, with a haughty bearing.

Yama is black, his reddish-yellow hair standing upright, short and potbellied. Varuṇa is white, his head marked by a serpent's hood, with a graceful body. Kubera is yellow, wearing a jewel crown, with a haughty bearing. Īśāna is white, with a crown of matted locks, his body short and large. Agni, the god of fire, is red, with a crown of matted locks, his body marked by a crown ornament. The rākṣasa is smoke-colored, with loosened hair and a short body. Vāyu is green, wearing a jewel crown, with a haughty bearing. Above is the Great Grandfather (Brahmā), yellow, short and potbellied, with a crown of matted locks. Below is the earth goddess Pṛthivī, yellow, wearing a jewel crown, with a playful body.

One should see those obstructing vināyakas, seized by Yamāntaka and the others, terrified and enfeebled, bent on seeking refuge.

After that, from the seed syllable at one's own heart, one emanates spikes with the heads of wrathful ones, black in color, greatly terrible, as hard to bear

as the fire at the destruction of an eon, topped by the form of Amṛtakuṇḍalin. One imagines them handed to Yamāntaka and the others, and then, into the heads of the hosts of obstructors, one should drive the stakes with this: oṃ gha gha ghātaya sarva duṣṭaṃ phaṭ phaṭ kīlaya kīlaya sarva pāpaṃ phaṭ hūṃ hūṃ vajra kīla vajra dharo ajñāpayati sarva duṣṭa vighanī kāya vākcitta vajra kīlaya hūṃ phaṭ. This is the kīla mantra. One should strike them with this: oṃ vajra muṅgara vajra kīlaya ākoṭaya ākotaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. All the wrathful ones, their own emblems transformed, are visualized as vajra hammers, and they drive in the mantra stakes and strike. For as long as it takes for the obstructors to go into the ground, one should drive in the stakes and strike.

Then one imagines Yamāntaka and the others entering their own emanations. After that, at the time of unifying them, one sees the misleaders and their retinues destroyed at the root by the fire of the wrathful ones.

Now, with the letter ra one visualizes a sun in front, and on that sun a crossed vajra generated by hūṃ. With that very vajra one visualizes the fence and the canopy bound together; the syllable "and" indicates a net of vajra arrows. A vajra canopy and a ground made of vajra are taught, and one should imagine it reaching down to the foundation of the earth element. From the phrase "dispelling obstructors," the circle of protection is stated for the purpose of pacifying obstructors.

"After that, as the gathering of all entities without remainder, one should recite the mantra of the reality of the essence": by that very means, analyzing all phenomena, whatever is form is the essence, and gathering it is collecting it. The mantra is oṃ śūnyatā jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ. Immediately after, having made manifest the meaning of the mantra, that oneself and the three realms are without entity, one should meditate. This is the intense conviction in emptiness.

In its center, one meditates on wisdom pervading the expanse of space, in the form of the white syllable e. "Upon it" means that in its center, upon space, is the ground. Definitely, by this sequence, gathering together the maṇḍalas of the four great elements beginning with wind, one should imagine the celestial palace adorned with the eight charnel grounds.

Then, by application in their proper sequence, the charnel grounds should be described. In the east is the charnel ground called Caṇḍogra. In a śirīṣa tree is a being of great magical power, elephant-faced and white. The lord of that direction is Indra, white-yellow and thousand-eyed, mounted on the white

Airāvata. The nāga king is Vāsuki, yellow. The cloud is Thunder-Roaring, of various colors. The mountain is Meru, made of the four kinds of precious substance. The stūpa, called White Vajra, is white.

In the south is the great charnel ground called Terrible Skull-Bearer. In a mango tree is a being of great magical power, buffalo-faced and black. The guardian of that direction is Yama, black, riding a buffalo. The nāga is Padma, white. The cloud is Cloud-Repeller, of various colors. The mountain is Malaya, white. The stūpa is called Black Vajra.

In the west is the great charnel ground called Jvālākula. In a kaṅkeli tree is a being of great magical power, sea-monster-faced and white. The lord of that direction is Varuṇa, white. The nāga is Karkoṭa, red. The cloud is Unbearable, of various colors. The mountain is Kailāsa, white. The stūpa is called Red Vajra.

In the north is the great charnel ground called Gahvara. In an aśvattha tree is a being of great magical power, human-faced and white. The lord of that direction is Kubera, yellow, with a human mount. The nāga is Takṣaka, black. The cloud is Encircler, of various colors. The mountain is Mandara, green. The stūpa is called Formation Vajra.

In the northeast is the great charnel ground called Lakṣmīvana. In a nyagrodha tree is a being of great magical power, ox-faced and white. The lord of that direction is Maheśvara (Śiva), white, with a white bull as his mount. The nāga is Śaṅkhapāla, yellow. The cloud is Fierce, of various colors. The mountain is Mahendra, king of mountains, black. The stūpa is called Mind Vajra.

In the southeast is the great charnel ground called Aṭṭahāsa. In a karañja tree is a being of great magical power, goat-faced and red. The guardian of that direction is Agni, red, with a goat as his seat. The nāga is Mahāpadma, green. The cloud is Dense, of various colors. The mountain is Gandhamādana, yellow. The stūpa is called Body Vajra.

In the southwest is the great charnel ground called Ghorāndhakāra. In a parkaṭa tree is a being of great magical power, corpse-faced and black. The lord of that direction is the rākṣasa, corpse-faced and black. The nāga is Ananta, white. The cloud is Filler, of various colors. The mountain is the Snow Mountain, white. The stūpa is called Jewel Vajra.

In the northwest is the great charnel ground called Kilikilārava. In a pāṭali tree is a being of great magical power, deer-faced and green. The lord of that direction is Vāyu, riding a deer. The nāga is Kulika, wrathful. The cloud is

Rain-Bringer, of various colors. The mountain is Śrīparvata, blue. The stūpa is called Dharma Vajra.

Within them one should also imagine the beings of great magical power, holding in the left hand a human skull cup filled with blood, and in the right a hand with a lotus, drawing forth various corpses.

After that, one should imagine the eight charnel grounds as follows. They are dense with trees bearing various flowers, adorned with leaves sprouting green and yellow shoots; they are adorned with various birds such as crows, cuckoos, owls, parrots, mynas, horned owls male and female, and vultures; they are filled with various wild animals such as lions, wolves, tigers, bears and boars; they are stirred by the wafting fragrance of flowers of various sweet scents; they are filled with hosts of various snakes; their various places and quarters are adorned with skulls, skeletons, skull cups, corpses and the like. Furthermore, in their various quarters they are fully adorned with dwellings, temples, meditation huts and ponds, and with hosts of yogins and yoginīs, male and female renunciants, male and female meditators, yakṣas and yakṣiṇīs, pretas male and female, rākṣasas and rākṣasīs, kumbhāṇḍas male and female, bhūtas male and female, ḍākas and ḍākinīs, and heroes and heroines. They are filled with hosts of ḍākas and ḍākinīs whose minds delight in the symbols of the pledge, who have attained laughter, grace, embraces, kisses of every kind and the like.

After that, with joyful minds, some dance with vajra steps; some sing vajra songs; some engage in the various practices of the pledge; some eat the five nectars and the five lamps; some offer various things; some fully satisfy various beings; and some one should see drinking liquor. Others play various instruments: kettledrums, ḍamarus, drums, paṭaha drums, kṛviḍa drums, one-faced drums, lutes, flutes, clappers and the like. Furthermore, the charnel grounds are filled with many siddhas, vidyādharas male and female, mahoragas male and female, kinnaras male and female, gandharvas male and female and the like, and with hosts of gods, asuras and garuḍas. They resound with the cry kīli kī; they are terrible, dense and fearsome; and they are blessed and inhabited by hosts of vetālas and bhūtas who delight the mind completely with the nine moods of dance.

The eight charnel grounds are the purification of the eight consciousnesses. The eight consciousnesses are the five consciousnesses beginning with the eye consciousness, the foundation consciousness, the mental consciousness,

and the afflicted mental consciousness. The eight charnel grounds are to be understood as the purification of the eight examples: a mirror, a dream, an illusion, a mirage, a city of gandharvas, an echo, the moon in water, and space. Thus the eight charnel grounds: because, through full understanding of all phenomena, the apprehended object, the apprehending subject and so forth are abandoned, the eight charnel grounds are understood through the example of the eight consciousnesses.

That being stated, one should describe the celestial palace, which is the transformation of the four great elements beginning with wind. The four doors are the purification of the four applications of mindfulness. The four right abandonments are taught as the four porticoes. The four bases of miraculous power, purified, are the four platforms. The five faculties are the four walls and the vajra line. The five powers are the four corners and the nets and half-nets. Through the purification of the noble eightfold path the eight pillars are fully established; and the seven limbs of awakening are the pennants, the parapets, the parasols, the yak-tail whisks, the canopies, the bells and the banners. The celestial palace is the purification of the thirty-seven factors of awakening.

By the words "one should meditate on clear light," the celestial palace is meant; by that it arises from its own nature as the nature of the meaning of the factors of awakening. Nevertheless, it should be understood as it is stated separately for the generation, and by its nature one should contemplate the sequence of the grounds and so forth.

Next, the divisions of the factors of awakening will be stated through the kindness of the noble Saroruhapāda. Here, first, the generation of the body: from its property, everything possessing that property is empty; therefore the body is generated first. By the word "subsequent": its lack of essence is the nature of its property, and afterward one recollects whatever is the nature of its property. Because there is no generation, it is the nature of the reality of all the previous entities of form without exception. If, after that, it is stated by the word "mindfulness" that it is the nature of mind, then how does it appear vividly? It is an imputed aspect; otherwise the nature is not like that. Moreover, just like a reflection in a mirror, the generation appears vividly in aspects that are individually examined.

What is meant by the word "application"? It is placing from supreme to supreme; this is application. The supreme is clear light, expressed by the word "mindfulness." Arising from that and abiding, by this cause one examines the

eastern door as having come about thus: through the purification of the application of mindfulness to the body, there is the eastern door. Likewise, through the purification of the application of mindfulness to feeling, there is the southern door. Likewise, through the purification of the application of mindfulness to phenomena, there is the western door. Likewise, through the purification of the application of mindfulness to mind, there is the northern door.

If one asks how this is so: once form has been set aside, feeling is not realized as anything other, perception likewise, and consciousness also becomes likewise. Nevertheless, like an illusion, like a dream, like a city of gandharvas, so do the doors appear vividly.

Likewise, form, feeling, perception, formations and consciousness are established; all phenomena are likewise, and consciousness too is momentary. How so? When it is analyzed, it does not hold up. What does "when it is analyzed" mean? Consciousness is established by whatever phenomena there are, and it is truly said that these are momentary and without essence. Therefore consciousness too is momentary. How so? When all phenomena are analyzed, they are like such things as a pot hammered out of gold and the like. Just as such a thing does not exist when its substance does not exist, so, when all phenomena do not exist, consciousness does not exist. Therefore consciousness too is momentary. Just as, when the object to be grasped becomes without substance, there is no grasper, so, when there is neither the grasped nor the grasper, there is no grasping. Moreover, just as grasping abides by apprehending the object to be grasped, so, when these are absent, there is no grasping. The remaining form is not known as anything other than the purification of generating the great doors; so one should contemplate the four doors that have come about in this way. They are emanations, momentary in nature.

On "The four right abandonments are remembered as the four porticoes": they are the antidote to evils that have not arisen, the cutting off of evils that have arisen, the generating of virtues that have not arisen, and the dedication of virtues that have arisen to buddhahood; that is, the antidote, the cutting off, the generating and the dedication. If one asks what is the antidote to what: it is the antidote to the afflictions such as attachment. When they have not yet arisen, that which harms the afflictions that are about to arise is the antidote. Even when afflictions such as attachment have arisen, one meditates on this in order to destroy them, that is, in order to cut them off. Therefore, through

their destruction these are absent, and thus the state free of afflictions arises. Wishing to make what has arisen something shared in common with sentient beings is what is called dedication. Through the purification of the four right abandonments there are the porticoes.

Through the purification of the four bases of miraculous power there are the four plinths: faith, diligence, investigation and mind. Faith is intense devotion of intention. Likewise, diligence is intense aspiration, uninterrupted. Investigating without interruption by that very means is investigation. "Investigation" also means investigating, through that very nature, both oneself and others. The generating of mind as its own form is the culmination of mind; therefore it actualizes the culmination of mind. Thus the purification of the four bases of miraculous power is the four plinths. "Generating miraculous power" refers to the aspect purified through the purification of emanation: its body that emanates and gathers back, as one wishes, is miraculous power. Actualizing this aspect is generation; therefore, apart from that, there is no entry into the aspect of the vajra nature.

On "The five faculties are the four walls and the vajra lines": the faculty of faith, the faculty of mindfulness, the faculty of diligence, the faculty of meditative absorption and the faculty of wisdom. Conviction, as the first taking up of the cause, is expressed by the word faith, because it is intense devotion. The second is engagement: having by oneself rejected turning back to anything else, one bound by the karma of saṃsāra, having attained it, engages for as long as saṃsāra lasts; this is expressed by the word faith. The third: that which arises, without fashioning any aspect, merely by the mind engaging without interruption, day and night, in the yoga of "I," is expressed by the words faculty of mindfulness. One-pointedness of mind is the fourth. By the word "peak" is meant the correct path; being together with it is one-pointedness of mind, which is expressed by the word meditative absorption, and by the word urasa it is expressed otherwise. "Of the vajra lines" refers to the five lines (rekhā) and the five walls, distinguished according to the division of the five tathāgatas, and in their center is the palace of the buddha. The word vajra means equal together with all, and vajra means indivisible. By the words faculty of wisdom it is made clear that all phenomena are utterly without abiding. At that time they are perfectly equal, because among the tathāgatas there is no difference from one another. "By the nature of the vajra holder" means "adorned with the vajra lines": one should contemplate the house of meditative concentration adorned with these walls.

On "The corners, the necklaces and the half-necklaces are the powers": the power of faith, the power of diligence, the power of mindfulness, the power of meditative absorption and the power of wisdom. Conviction is the first continuum, and the power of the fulfillment of the cause; because it completes the actualization of power, it is expressed by the words power of faith. For its sake, having made the mind steady without interruption, one engages: this is the power of diligence. Moreover, not apprehending the mind there even for an instant, remembering that yoga day and night is the power of mindfulness. "When it has become one-pointedness of mind": the words "as it has become" mean the supreme path of not apprehending any phenomena, and actualizing it, that indivisibility itself, is expressed by the words meditative absorption. Likewise, the purification of the four powers is the four corners; because they are filled by the four faculties, they are the four powers. The word "filled" is used because it subsequently makes the meaning full. By the power of wisdom there are the necklaces and the half-necklaces, and here power is stated explicitly. Fully filling that non-abiding of all phenomena which was made clear by the faculty of wisdom is actualization. The indivisible nature, through the power of wisdom, is the meditation on the necklaces and half-necklaces; that is what this expresses.

The eight pillars are examined as the eight branches of the noble path. "Not abandoning what one has undertaken" is right view. "Undeceiving speech" is right speech.

"Never transgressing the ten virtues" is right thought. "A mind that does no harm to sentient beings" is right action. A mind single-pointed on the ten virtues is right livelihood. "A mind utterly without self" is right effort; "effort" means cutting off existence and nonexistence. Knowing the three times in a single instant is right mindfulness. The body in which the three worlds themselves are one is right meditative absorption. Through these the pillars are rightly examined.

The seven branches of awakening are the pennants, the arrow-screens, the parasols, the yak-tail whisks, the canopies, the bells and the banners. "Mindfulness that fully knows the three times everywhere" is the branch of awakening that is right mindfulness. Uninterruptedly realizing the great taste itself is the branch of awakening that is the thoroughly purified gathering of phenomena. "Engaging without interruption through the great yoga" is the branch of awakening that is the thoroughly gathered diligence. Because there is no joy in anything other than selflessness, it is the branch of awakening that

is the thoroughly gathered joy. The application called "the inseparability of emptiness and compassion everywhere" is the branch of awakening that is the thoroughly gathered pliancy. "Fully attaining unmistaken meditative absorption" is the branch of awakening that is the thoroughly gathered meditative absorption. Spontaneously accomplished engagement in meditative absorption is the branch of awakening that is the thoroughly gathered equanimity. One should contemplate the pennants and the rest as expressed by these seven branches of awakening. This culmination of meditating on the palace as the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening is, first, omniscience as manifest awakening into emptiness and the rest.

Now I shall explain the generation of the causal vajra holder. Inside the palace, on a variegated lotus, one should visualize the four māras pressed down upon the sun. In the Hevajra, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara and the lord of the gods (Indra) are the aggregates, the lord of death, the afflictions and the son of the gods; these are the four māras, the afflicters of the aggregates. Then, having visualized a sun disc upon it, one doubles the vowels beginning with the letter i upon it, and having viewed them in forward and reverse order, one should meditate on the moon disc arising from their transformation. This is mirror-like wisdom, which makes clear the thirty-two marks of a great being. Having added the six letters ḍa ḍha da dha ya la, one doubles the letters beginning with ka, and having viewed them in forward and reverse order, one should visualize the sun disc arising from their transformation. This has the nature of the wisdom of equality, which makes clear the eighty minor marks. Upon these one visualizes the two seeds hūṃ and oṃ, and then the skull cup and the curved knife arising from them, marked with the two seeds; this is discriminating wisdom. Light rays radiate from the seeds and illuminate the infinite world-systems, and one should meditate that they are gathered back, enter those very seeds, and all become one; this is the wisdom that accomplishes activities. All of that transforms, and in an instant one is oneself the body of glorious Heruka; this is the utterly pure wisdom of the dharmadhātu. It is fivefold: just as forms are seen by mirror-like wisdom, so by the wisdom of equality they become of one taste; by discriminating wisdom they are discerned; and likewise by the wisdom that accomplishes activities whatever is to be done is made one; and the utterly pure wisdom of the dharmadhātu is the form that is one together with all aspects. This is the fivefold manifest awakening.

Then, having imagined the body of the three worlds, one meditates on the eight seats: at the doors, beginning with the east, in due order, Brahmā, the Indras, Upendra and the Rudras; and likewise at the intermediate directions, beginning with Īśāna, Yama, the Leader of Wealth, the rākṣasa and Vemacitrin. Upon them, in the centers of a moon and a sun joined face to face, one should visualize the eight seeds gaṃ caṃ baṃ ghaṃ baṃ śaṃ laṃ naṃ. Their transformations are the emblems of Gaurī and the others: one imagines the curved knife, the hand drum, the tortoise, the snake, the lion, the monk, the wheel and the vajra. Blessed by these, all of them transform into one, and one should visualize Gaurī and the others in their completeness. This sets out the maṇḍala to be meditated upon.

Now I shall explain the purification of these, and their hand emblems and the rest.

"Then, through tender love, the two eyes are red."

"Tender love" is the mind toward sentient beings like the love for an only child; therefore the two eyes are red.

"Through the mind of loving-kindness, the limbs are black."

"Through the mind of loving-kindness" means the cessation of the aggregates, the elements and the sense faculties; therefore, through the mind of loving-kindness, the limbs are black.

"The vajra-bearer's three eyes are pure."

This means that the absence of obscurations of body, speech and mind is the three vajras.

"By the four means of gathering,
The four feet are to be remembered."

The means of gathering are generosity, pleasant speech, examining the aim, and consistency of aim. "Giving birth to the mind in the inconceivable itself" is generosity. When the mind is given birth in the inconceivable, joy is just as bliss is; this is to be understood from the instructions as they are given. Just as gold is tested by burning, cutting and rubbing, so the words "consistency of aim" are the name for the single body of all. Such is the purification of the four feet.

The eight faces are the purification of the liberations: seeing form as empty, seeing the absence of opportunity as empty, seeing the attainment of the

cognition of the attractive and the unattractive as empty, seeing the attainment of what is made by view as empty, seeing the attainment of space as empty, seeing the attainment of nothingness as empty, seeing the attainment of the cognition of selflessness as empty, and seeing the cessation of right awareness as empty. These, the purification of the eight liberations, are the faces. "Liberation" means attaining the bliss in which all faults have been abandoned, because it is the cessation of the cognition that rightly knows great bliss, oneself and others.

"The hands are the sixteen emptinesses" refers to the emptiness of the inner, the emptiness of the outer, the emptiness of the outer and inner, the emptiness of emptiness, the great emptiness, the emptiness of the ultimate, the emptiness of the conditioned, the emptiness of the unconditioned, the emptiness of what is beyond extremes, the emptiness of what has neither beginning nor end, the emptiness of intrinsic nature, the emptiness of what is not intrinsic nature, the emptiness of all phenomena, the emptiness of nonentities, the emptiness of own essential nature, and the emptiness of the intrinsic nature of nonentities. These are the sixteen emptinesses.

Now I shall explain the meaning of emptiness. The inner emptiness of all phenomena: this is the emptiness of the inner. The outer aspects of all phenomena being just so is the emptiness of the outer. The union of emptiness and compassion as inseparable comes from the guru's instructions; thus it is the emptiness of the outer and inner. Whatever arises from inseparable union is expressly called the great emptiness. Whatever is empty of the great union is called the emptiness of emptiness. Therefore the ultimate, supreme among the supreme and highest, is the emptiness of the ultimate. These are six emptinesses.

What is made one by all the aspects of what is manifestly conditioned is the emptiness of the conditioned. "Unconditioned" means that there are no formations, and that all kinds of arising are joined in one. "Endowed with the supreme of all aspects" is the emptiness of what is beyond extremes. "The emptiness of what has neither beginning nor end" is so called because it is inseparable from that. "The emptiness of the absence of intrinsic nature" is what comes from the intrinsic nature that is the form of the deity. "The aspect of the five" is an aspect that is empty: this is the emptiness of intrinsic nature. "The intrinsic nature of what lacks intrinsic nature is the Perfection of Wisdom that lacks intrinsic nature": this is the emptiness of the absence of intrinsic nature. The stable and the moving, even the subtlest particles, are all

phenomena; because they are expressed by the words "all phenomena," all that is expressed is empty: this is the emptiness of all phenomena. What is meant by "nonentity"? Seeing an essence in all beings, like a firebrand wheel, comes from their nature; because the essence of the nature is reckoned so, it is the emptiness of nonentities. "Intrinsic nature" is the emptiness of intrinsic nature. When the element of space and consciousness have become one, it is like the way form has become; this is called the emptiness of nonentities. These emptinesses are declared to be the purification of the hands.

Next I shall explain the purification of the colors of the faces. The first face is black, for the purpose of accomplishing the actions of aversion, and also because the sense faculties are without obscuration. The left face is red, for the purpose of accomplishing the bringing under control; the nature in which body, speech and mind are one is control itself. The right face is white, for the purpose of pacifying; the pride of the deity's own purity with respect to the aggregates, elements and sense sources is pacifying. The upper face, baring its fangs and the color of smoke, is for the purpose of destroying afflictions such as aversion that arise in later times. Likewise, the four faces resembling bees are for the purpose of destroying the four māras. Disease that depends on the aggregates is called the māra of the aggregates; the aggregates becoming a mere heap is the māra of death; what harms sentient beings is the māra of the afflictions; and likewise, agitation toward women is called the māra of the son of the gods. The four faces resembling bees are for the purpose of destroying the four māras.

I shall explain the purification of the hand emblems. The elephant and the other things held are for the sake of pacifying the various afflictions. "The various afflictions" refers to coughing, breathlessness, and likewise madness, wasting, leprosy, swellings and tumors; the elephant and the rest by nature are fully said to be these. Here the sentient beings who have fallen into the hand of those eight afflictions are held up on the vessels; this is the meaning of "held." The emblems held in the left hands, from Earth through the Wealth Holder, signify the full accomplishment of the eight lordships:

"Lordship of body, lordship of speech,
Likewise lordship of mind,
Of miraculous power, and of going,
Of desire, of agency, and of qualities: these are the eight."

So it is said. An infinite body is lordship of body. Speaking the languages of all sentient beings is lordship of speech. Knowing the minds of sentient beings is lordship of mind. Seeing infinite world-systems through miraculous power is lordship of miraculous power. The body in which the three worlds are one is lordship of going everywhere. Because sentient beings ardently desire the nature of great bliss, it is lordship of desire; by the word "desire," the desire for desire is expressed. "Agent" means lordship of agency, through the agent who is the vajra holder himself. Passing into nirvāṇa from the form of the profound deity, and, having passed into nirvāṇa, moving about in the form of the deity, is lordship of qualities. This is the purification of the emblems.

I shall explain the purification of the vessels. The vessels are what makes the aspect of compassion clear, and the hands are the purity of the sixteen emptinesses; this makes clear the inseparability of emptiness and compassion.

"The five buddhas of the mothers": "mothers" (mātṛkās) are the consorts, who are the purity of the five tathāgatas.

"Seal" means what fully covers: the wheel, the earrings, the necklace, the armlets on the arms, the girdle and the ashes. These are well known as the six seals. "Seal" means right knowing. "Right knowing" means that where there is no essence of a knowing, whatever form there is comes to be rightly known. The garland of heads on the shoulders is made from the fifty letters: through the purity of the fifty letters of the āli and kāli, the garland of heads at the neck reveals the path of union.

Now I shall explain the nine sentiments of the dance. Being of one taste with Nairātmyā is the erotic. Dwelling in the charnel ground is the heroic. The wrathful frown and bared fangs are the repulsive. The blazing light is the fierce. The beaming face is the comic. Wearing a garland of moist heads is the terrifying. The mind that cares for sentient beings is the compassionate. The illusory form is the marvelous. Because the afflictions such as attachment have been utterly abandoned, it is the peaceful. The Blessed One, together with these nine dances, is the very self who has become the cause.

The garlands of five dry skulls on the forehead make the five aggregates clear. The crown is marked with a crossed vajra because he accomplishes manifold aims. Because his form is omniscient and because he fully knows the three times, each face has three eyes. His reddish-yellow hair is shown standing on end in order to burn up all the afflictions such as attachment. He is naked

because all phenomena are made clear without obscuration. He stands in the dancing posture of the half cross-legged position because he has attained the foot of the awakening mind. One toe is shown because all three worlds are made clear as one. The Blessed One appears momentarily. As with the Blessed One, so too with the Blessed Lady; there is a difference, in that, by virtue of a single shape, she has one face. In her left hand she holds a skull cup filled with the blood of gods and asuras. What do the words "gods and asuras" mean? The gods are body, speech and mind, and their objects are the asuras. Their non-action is acting without attachment and without an object; the skull cup is filled with that. "Making the skull cup and the blood one" shows that the meaning of the Perfection of Wisdom is made full. In her right hand she holds a curved knife in order to cut off the afflictions without remainder. Whatever else remains is to be understood of the Blessed Lady in the same way as the purification of the Blessed One.

Now one imagines four wheels in the body of the pledge vajra holder to be accomplished: beginning with the emanation wheel, they are the wheels of dharma, of enjoyment, of emanation and of great bliss, for the sake of the purification of the four bodies.

Now I shall explain the purification of the maṇḍala deities. Gaurī is black in order to awaken the sentient beings to be tamed who belong to māra. In her right hand she holds a curved knife in order to cut off wrong views, and in her left a rohita fish in order to destroy the habitual tendencies of saṃsāra. Caurī is red in order to awaken the sentient beings to be tamed through attachment; in her right hand is a hand drum, to make clear the very nature of wisdom and means, and in her left a pig, for the purpose of destroying delusion. Vetālī, with the radiance of refined gold, is for the purpose of taming sentient beings who are fully developed; this means for the sake of generating bliss. In her right hand is a tortoise, to make the meaning of emptiness clear, and in her left a lotus vessel, the nature of compassion. Ghasmarī, like a marakata emerald, slightly reddish green, holds a vajra; this is for the purpose of awakening people who look to killing in performing fierce rites. In her right hand is a snake, through the purification of aversion, and in her left the vessel of yoga, the very self of means and wisdom. Pukkasī is blue, for the purpose of awakening proud sentient beings in accomplishing the aim of immobilizing. In her right hand is a lion, to vanquish the hosts of māra, and in her left an axe, which cuts off dualistic grasping without remainder. Śabarī is white, in order to awaken peaceful sentient beings. In her right hand is a monk, who makes the

five wisdoms clear, and in her left a monk's staff, because she realizes nondual wisdom. Caṇḍālī, green like the sky and rigid, is for awakening sentient beings who are rigid in accomplishing their aims. In her right hand is a wheel, to cut off even the slightest bit of knowing, and in her left a plough, for the purpose of turning back the stain of ignorance from its root. Ḍombī, of many colors, is for accomplishing manifold aims and for awakening people of savage intent. In her right hand is a vajra, to make clear the wisdom of not knowing, and one is to recall her threatening finger, for threatening all the savage without exception.

Now I shall explain the purification of their eight seats. Attachment, knowledge, learning, avarice, eating, sleep, conceptual thought and faith: the seats are taught in order to cut off excessive clinging. Excessive clinging applies even to meditative concentration. Thus the purification of the seats is explained.

All of these are to be meditated upon as three-eyed, with reddish-yellow hair standing on end, adorned with the five seals, standing in the dance of the half cross-legged posture, unclothed, baring their fangs, and endowed with the desire that desires the Blessed One.

Beyond that, on the deity band, Vīṇā and the others are placed at the main doors, beginning from the right, two goddesses each at the doors and at the corners. The first letter of each name, with a moon crescent and a drop, is their seed. Having visualized their emblems, generated by these seeds and marked with those same seeds, in the center of a moon and a sun, one should contemplate as follows: "Just as Gaurī and the others were completed, so Vīṇā and the others are generated."

They are as follows: Vīṇā, yellow; Vaṃśā, red; Mukundā, smoke-colored; Murajā, white; Hāsyā, yellow; Lāsyā, red; Gītā, red; Nṛtyā, multicolored; Puṣpā, white; Dhūpā, black; Dīpā, golden; Gandhā, yellow; the Mirror Goddess, white; Rasā, red; Sparśā, green; and Dharmā, white. They hold their own emblems in their right hands, and their feet rest on moon seats. One should visualize them as the purification of the sixteen digits. Thus, beginning with the variegated lotus, the body of the causal vajra holder is completed, and with the culmination of the maṇḍala deities there is manifest awakening as the knowledge of the path.

Then, now, one should imagine the nature of the subtle maṇḍala encircled by two garlands of red hoḥ syllables. According to the instructions: the gandharva

mind, whose nature is great bliss and which is intensely passionate, is drawn in by one's own light rays and made to enter as the pith instructions describe. Merely by its entering, the Blessed One, in a single taste of utterly supreme great bliss, together with his own consort, becomes passionate and ever more passionate, melts, and comes to abide in the form of a seed.

Then the four goddesses, Pukkasī and the others, saying, "We have no protector," fall into great sorrow, and with minds in utter distress they entreat the Blessed One to arise with songs that awaken him. Here I shall explain the meaning of the four verses of arising, which begin "Arise, O lord, whose mind is compassion."

"Arise, you who have a mind of compassion, and protect me, Pukkasī! Make love to me in the union of great bliss! With your melted form itself, abandon the meditative absorption of emptiness!" This is my great love toward you.

"Without you I shall die. O Hevajra of emptiness, arise, and accomplish the aim of the Śabarī woman!" This is my great compassion toward you.

"Having invited the world as your guests, why, O lord of joy, do you remain in emptiness? I, Caṇḍālī, make this entreaty: separated from you I do not know the directions," which means "I do not see." That is why she says "Arise!" This is my great joy toward you.

"O illusion, arise! I know your mind. I, Ḍombī, am most wise and clever, and delightful. Do not cut off your compassion!" This is my abiding in great equanimity toward you.

This shows the melted form through the purification of the four realities: the reality of food, the reality of the deity, the reality of mantra and the reality of wisdom. Then one should come to understand the meaning of the four realities in sequence, just as it is in the guru's instructions; it is not stated here for fear of making the text too long. Therefore, if one has become the Blessed One endowed with that very form, then, through the application of that very song, one arises as if waking from sleep.

Even so, others say: "If the Blessed One, by a mind joined with utter selflessness, is himself selfless, then what is this seeing of a dream of space? How does the Blessed One arise as if waking from sleep?" To this it is said: In the state of sleep sentient beings know nothing at all; then how is it seen that they rise from it? It is by the force of some task that they get up in an instant, as if startled. In the same way the Blessed One, absorbed in the meditative

absorption of emptiness, does not know awareness of self and other. Then, urged on by the song of reality, he arises by the force of his aspiration.

Even so, there are two questions. First: living beings, having taken bodily comfort as their object, do not know anything in the state of sleep, yet because they have a body they rise; is the Blessed One like that? How does he arise? Second: if the mantra practitioner first makes the impure body pure, and then, through the purification by emptiness and the rest, out of clinging to the emanation body, why does one again attain melting by which one is no emanation at all, because one is free of bones, marrow and the rest? These are the two questions.

To this it is said: The attainment of melting in the first place is the cause, not the result. Thus, from the purity of the attainment of melting and the rest, the resultant vajra holder is also taken up; and so the first question is disposed of. Likewise the second: from the outset, through the form of the deity, there is no impure body, and when there is no impure body there is only clinging to the pure emanation body. Since that too is absent, one abides in the form of consciousness, like the nectar fluid and the moon, resembling a dream or an illusion. Therefore illusory consciousness is the support of aspiration. Just as an illusion, though it does not know awareness of self and other, still performs its tasks, so illusory consciousness, otherwise than by knowing self and other, arises by the force of long-standing aspiration.

The sequence of arising here is according to the fivefold yoga: "The nectar fluid, the form of the moon." Through the transformation of this nectar fluid there is the awakening mind whose nature is the five wisdoms. From it, the transformation of the āli is mirror-like wisdom, which is the moon. From the transformation of the kāli comes the wisdom of equality, the sun. The seed placed in their center is called discriminating wisdom. The oneness of all of them is the accomplishment of activities, and the completion of the form is the pure nature of reality. Therefore it is the awakening mind whose nature is the five wisdoms.

With the light rays that rise from it, one draws in all that moves and does not move, makes it of one taste in that very maṇḍala, and should then view it as the awakening mind in the form of the autumn moon. This is the samādhi called Yoga.

After that, in an instant, that form is transformed, and one should imagine the Innate Hevajra, in the form of the autumn hare-bearing moon, illuminating

infinite world systems, endowed with the Dharma seal, whose nature is the five wisdoms. This is the samādhi called Subsequent Yoga.

Then one should undertake the placement on the aggregates, the elements and the sense sources. On form one places the syllable aṃ. On feeling one brings the syllable iṃ. On perception one meditates on the long īṃ. On formations one places uṃ. On consciousness one places the syllable aṃ. This is for the purification of the five aggregates. On flesh one places the syllable uṃ. On blood one also recollects ṛṃ. On the awakening mind is the syllable ṛṃ. On marrow and fat one places the syllable ḷṃ. This is for the purification of the elements. On the objects of sight is ḷṃ. On sound one places the syllable eṃ. On the domain of smell, the syllable aiṃ, and on taste, again the syllable oṃ. On the tangible is the syllable oṃ. On the dharmadhātu is the syllable oṃ. Because these are the very cause that makes them stable, the Blessed One said in the ninth chapter:

"In the aggregate of form is Vajrā;
In feeling, Gaurī is recollected;
In perception, Vāriyoginī;
Vajraḍākinī in formations;
In the mode of the aggregate of consciousness
Abides Nairātmyāyoginī.
In visible form, Gaurī is always declared;
In sound, Caurī is renowned;
In the domain of smell, Vetālī;
In taste, Ghasmarī is recollected;
In touch, Bhūcarī is declared;
And Khecarī in the dharmadhātu.
In flesh, Pukkasī is taught;
In blood, Śabarī is renowned;
Caṇḍālī is declared to be the semen;
Ḍombī is in marrow and fat."

This is the samādhi called Great Yoga. By it there is placement on the aggregates, the elements and the sense sources. So too, for that reason, it is said again:

"First is awakening through emptiness;
Second, gathering the seed;
Third, the completion of the form;

And fourth, the placement of syllables.
At the navel, the heart, the throat,
And the forehead are thus four lotuses,
Of sixty-four, eight, sixteen,
And thus, in order, thirty-two.
Therefore, through meditation, there
One imagines all, with what moves and what does not move."

Then, with the mantras for blessing body, speech and mind taught in the chapter on mantras, one should bless body, speech and mind, as instructed in the oral instructions: with the syllable oṃ, the body vajra; with the syllable āḥ, the speech vajra; and with the syllable hūṃ, the mind vajra. This is the Great Yoga.

Now, "upon that": at the heart of the being, by the sequence explained before, the sequence taught in one's own sādhana, one should thus view, from among the four colored forms in the aspect of glorious Heruka, one's own chosen deity as the solitary hero, or else in union with Nairātmyā, together with one's own consort, as the embodiment of the complete body.

After that, one should undertake the three commitments: Vajradhara himself is the commitment of self; the sun at one's own heart is the commitment of wisdom; and the syllable hūṃ upon it is the commitment of samādhi. The two commitments of wisdom and samādhi are to be understood from the instruction that will be explained.

The placement is to be done for the Blessed Lady just as for the Blessed One. In addition, there is the assembly of the five families of the Blessed Lady, as is known from various other sādhanas. "Assembly" means the assembly of the tathāgatas.

With the syllable āḥ there is the three-petaled lotus, together with what delights it; with the syllable hūṃ, at the anthers of the lotus, the vajra generated from the syllable hūṃ, its jewel seen as the syllable hūṃ. Having blessed the lotus and the vajra with the two verses beginning oṃ mahāsukhadhara, one stirs the vajra, preceded by uttering the uncontrived syllables, and should commence the joys; this is from the Vajra King of Speech among the five Tathāgatas. That which begins with first intense devotion to emptiness and culminates in the bliss of joy is the samādhi called Initial Union.

Moreover, understanding that it has arisen from the awakening mind that comes from the great bliss in which wisdom and skillful means are of one taste, the yogin holding the garuḍa mudrā, preceded by reciting the three realities, should perform the approach with the tongue in the center of the city of the domain. Thus the worship of the Tathāgatas is constant. As for the outer practice too: is she an excellent wisdom consort or not? If she is not, then one should not do it, for it would become a root downfall.

After that, through the transformation of whatever drop of the awakening mind abides there, tiny and subtle, the size of an atom, one imagines in the center of the goddess's lotus the lord, together with the maṇḍala deities, arising from the union of churning and being churned. One then brings forth the hūṃ of Vajradhara, the aṃ of the Blessed Lady, the gaṃ of Gaurī, the caṃ of Caurī, the baṃ of Vetālī, the paṃ of Pukkasī, the śaṃ of Śabarī, the laṃ of Caṇḍālī and the ḍi of Ḍombī. With these and the rest, in the eastern and other gates in their proper order, one brings forth the eight goddesses, Gaurī and the others, and with the syllable hūṃ and the syllable aṃ, the Blessed One and the Blessed Lady. Then one makes the Blessed One fully enter the Blessed Lady, and likewise the Blessed Lady the Blessed One. Beginning with the entry of the gandharva's consciousness and culminating in the emanation of the maṇḍala, this is manifest awakening as omniscience.

After that, one should meditate on the goddesses Gaurī and the others, generated from the awakening mind. Thus one should properly meditate on the wheel of the maṇḍala as taught, surrounded by the host of consorts gathered there, with masses of light rays pervading the expanse of space.

Now the wisdom circle is to be summoned, made to enter, bound and pleased. Sending out light rays from the seed at one's own heart and spreading them into the expanse of space, one invites the wisdom beings. Having imagined them in front, one offers water for welcome, water for the feet and so on; having worshiped them properly, one praises them. With jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ one summons, makes enter, binds and satisfies them. The wisdom circle is made to enter the commitment circle, and when they have become one in every respect, one should generate the pride of the deity and contemplate the pride of wisdom at the heart. However one looks at it, the wisdom circle is just like oneself. Even so, after the entry, one contemplates at the heart the wisdom being, with two arms and one face, red, together with his consort, and at his heart the samādhi lord. Then, beginning with the Blessed Lady, one should contemplate Gaurī and the others in the same way. That which begins

with summoning the wisdom circle and culminates in making the wisdom circle enter is the complete realization of all aspects.

After that, when the wisdom circle and the commitment circle are made one, one invites with blazing light rays, and imagines in the sky the five Tathāgatas, who have taken the form of Heruka, embodied together with their maṇḍala. One looks to them, requesting, abhiṣañcintu māṃ sarbatathāgata, and those Tathāgatas, with hands holding the five victorious vases, recite the verse beginning "Just as at the moment of birth," and bathe oneself, saying, oṃ sarbatathāgata abhiṣeka samaya śrīye hūṃ. After that, saffron, sandalwood and various fragrances rise up, a rain of flowers falls, the sound of drums resounds, and with dance, music and the sounds of praise a joyful clamor rings out through endless world systems. One is thus empowered, and on the crown one becomes the Lord of Mind. The Blessed Lady too is marked by the Mind. Mind, the Eternal One, the Jewel Lord, Amitābha and Amoghasiddhi: these Tathāgatas seal Gaurī and the others. Further, these same Tathāgatas, in their proper order, mark Pukkasī and the others on the head.

Then Vīṇā and the others make offerings to the lord of their own domain. Holding a mirror, a vīṇā, a conch of perfume, a vessel filled with various tastes, a tangible object, and a source of phenomena filled with the awakening mind, Rūpavajrā and the others make offerings to the Blessed One.

"You are surrounded by the hosts of yoginīs;
You, having fully found the supreme through your own mind,
Adorn all beings, moving and unmoving;
With a mind of compassion you truly awaken all, without exception.
Through illusory elaboration the vajra is accomplished:
O Heruka, glorious king, delighted in mind!"

With this vajra song Locanā and the others praise the Blessed One. And the Tathāgatas, the bodhisattvas, the knowledge goddesses, the lords of the wrathful ones and the rest, abiding in the sky, praise him with heart mantras, near-heart mantras, garland mantras and eight-line mantras. That which begins with the empowerment and culminates in the praise is the peak realization.

After that, in front, there is a wind maṇḍala arisen from ya, adorned with a banner; at its heart a fire maṇḍala arisen from raṃ, marked with blazing flames. Upon it, on three heads born from the syllable āḥ, is a skull, again blessed by the syllable āḥ, red inside and white outside. In its center are bhūṃ

āṃ jṝṃ khaṃ hūṃ and laṃ maṃ pāṃ tāṃ bāṃ. These are transformed, and one should complete the five nectars and the five lamps. One sees it covered above by the syllable hūṃ and blessed by the syllable hūṃ. Then, from the fire blazing as it is fanned by the wind, it becomes like quicksilver; it is purified by the syllable hūṃ, realized by the syllable āḥ and made to blaze by the syllable oṃ. After that, with the light rays of the three realities one draws in the nectar of wisdom and makes it enter that very nectar. Having made them one, one stirs it with the vajra arisen from hūṃ, makes it of equal taste, and sees the vajra dissolve into the nectar. Having thus completed it, so that it has become exceedingly cool through the full entry of the nectar of wisdom of the Tathāgatas, one blesses it with the three realities, draws it in with light rays, and partakes of it with the vajra tongue arisen from hūṃ, as the embodiment of the deity together with the maṇḍala. That which begins with tasting the nectar and culminates in it is the gradual realization.

After that, through the practice of emanating the maṇḍala and the maṇḍala deities one by one, by whatever means and wherever there are beings to be trained, emanations go there, train them and return, and are gathered back into their own bodies. Having thus brought beings to maturity by this sequence, one should undertake the meditation on the six limbs. That which begins with the emanation and culminates in the benefit of beings is the samādhi of the Supreme King of the Maṇḍala.

Then, seeing the seed syllable of the universal monarch, the king of secret mantra, in the center of the moon and sun joined together, one meditates on the six limbs. From what does this arise? From the mass of light rays that come forth from the syllable hūṃ seated in the center of the moon and sun at one's own heart. Then at the heart of the wisdom being one meditates on the lord of the first samādhi, black. From his transformation one imagines a bindu, and its light rays come forth from the pores of the Blessed One's body. One sees the maṇḍala together with the maṇḍala deities as deep black; in the second, yellow; in the third, red; in the fourth, green; in the fifth, blue; and in the sixth, white. By this one meditates on the limbs, and having meditated on the six limbs, one should afterward dissolve the colors.

The expression "dissolve the colors" is understood in two ways. It expresses the pride of being the tathāgatas of the colors, in the sense of the divisions of pacifying and the rest, and it expresses the means of entering luminosity. Thus the words "the āli and kāli, emanated through exhalation and inhalation, are withdrawn, and one oneself enters into that very state and becomes one"

mean that the garlands of āli and kāli are emanated. From what? From exhalation: the āli and kāli come out by the path along which the breath goes out, and with their light rays they thoroughly purify the major and minor marks. The moving and the unmoving become one and are drawn into that very state, Gaurī and the others and Nairātmyā gather into oneself, and one oneself abides in the state of Vajradhara, in a nature free of conceptual elaboration.

Then: "one-faced and two-armed, white, and in the center of the joined moon, the hare-marked one, and sun, not apprehending entity or nonentity." Therefore, in the chapter on the families, the Saṃbhogakāya said:

Great wisdom abides in the body,
fully free of all conceptual thought.
It is what pervades all things;
though it abides in the body, it is not born of the body.

And likewise:

Just as in a mirror image, complete in all its limbs,
the form of the supreme First One is beautiful,
rich with the eighty minor marks and with the major marks,
so the body of Vajradhara is eternal.

This is the stage of self-blessing. Beginning with the welfare of beings and culminating in the coemergent, it is manifest awakening in a single instant.

Then: "abiding in the state of the seed." What is this? That coemergent is the seed. "At this point one should recall this" means that the four, laughing, gazing, embracing and union, are to be understood as fully purified. With the words "master, secret, wisdom, and the culmination of supreme great bliss," the divisions of the moments of joy are stated. The word "master" is the moment of variety, the first joy. The word "secret" is the moment of maturation, supreme joy. The word "wisdom" is the moment of consummation, the joy of cessation. The words "the culmination of supreme great bliss" are the moment free of characteristics, coemergent joy. Through union with the action seal (karmamudrā), the shadow of the coemergent merely opens a little. Through union with the wisdom seal it is perfectly joined. And through union with the great seal (mahāmudrā), there is once again no feeling. As it is said:

There, there is no beginning, middle or end,
no existence and no nirvāṇa.
This is supreme great bliss,
where there is neither self nor other.

Having recognized it in this way as the coemergent state, then "the Blessed One also enters luminosity": that is the meaning.

The words "the seed syllable, the moon and the sun become mingled" make clear that the three wisdoms are without essence. The words "of the nature of nectar" make the coemergent state stable. In the words "by the sequence of the form of a mass of light rays, like the tip of a lamp flame, one should focus for as long as," light rays are light rays. "The sequence of the form of a mass" means the assembly of the aggregates. "By the sequence" means entering in the sequence of the five aggregates. "Like the tip of a lamp flame" means that just as the tip of a lamp flame vanishes from the lamp in an instant, so the Blessed One, by the sequence of the aggregates, passes from form, form into feeling, likewise feeling into perception, likewise perception into formations, formations into consciousness, and consciousness into space, because it has no direction.

If one asks how the earlier withdrawal by Gaurī and the others takes place, this sequence should be stated. Having come forth through the āli and kāli, they make the whole of the three worlds one and set them in their proper order. Gaurī, taking up her own object, went into the Blessed One. Likewise Caurī, Vetālī and Ghasmarī went into feeling, perception and formations. Thus Pukkasī, taking up the element of solidity, went into the form element of Vajradhara. Likewise Śabarī, Caṇḍālī and Ḍombī went into water, fire and wind. Although the withdrawal by Gaurī and the others has taken place, the withdrawal by Pukkasī and the others is taught. Even so, a distinction should be stated: having relinquished their own elements, what withdrawal of form and the rest would there be? Rather, it is by taking them up at the time of sleep. Then, for Pukkasī and the others as well: where there are the grasped, the grasper and the grasping, the three wisdoms are purified, and in the nature of Khecarī, Bhūcarī and Nairātmyā they are form, namely what are expressed by the terms appearance, increase of appearance, and attainment of appearance.

The goddess Nairātmyā, having obtained both sides, went first of all into the consciousness of Vajradhara. From what is this known? From the words: "At

Nairātmyā's heart one sees the syllable aṃ on a moon disc, and by that very means the syllable aṃ and the moon disc melt together, and one should imagine the Blessed Lady fully entering the heart of the Blessed One." This is the withdrawal of the Blessed Lady. By this, beginning with the coemergent and culminating in luminosity, is the manifest awakening of the Dharma body (dharmakāya).

Then emergence from luminosity is to be stated. Here that luminosity is the supreme yoga. As for emergence: just as the coemergent arises from the vajra that appears individually as wisdom, and just as afterward, beginning with the coemergent, it culminated in luminosity, so from luminosity comes the coemergent, and from the coemergent one should meditate again by this very sequence, until awakening is attained.

"By the sequence of blessing in four sessions" means dawn, midday, afternoon and night: this is the sequence of meditation. After that, the yogin who has grown weary of the sequence of meditation should recite mantras. After that, having arisen from luminosity, one should also attend to meditation and the torma.

In this way too, beginning with the supreme, one completes oneself in the form of one's chosen deity by the sequence taught in the yoga of the coemergent Hevajra. Then, as for reciting mantras: having completed the Blessed One whose nature is the wheel of ḍākinīs, the later ones are as the earlier ones were. By the relation of action and agent, one should first contemplate the Blessed One, and after that the wheel of ḍākinīs. Giving the torma is just the same, except that, in order to tame the wicked, one should contemplate Vajradhara as wrathful in nature, and the application of the rites should also be performed relying on the six limbs.

Then, at the time of recitation, when reciting the mantras of Gaurī and the others, one embraces whichever of them is reciting and, following the Yoginīsaṃcāra, should contemplate the Blessed Lady in her place, and one recites Vajradhara's garland mantra, the eight-line mantra, the heart mantra and the near-heart mantra. Otherwise, one should recite only the heart mantras of Nairātmyā and of Gaurī and the others.

The sequence for this is as follows. Viewing oneself in the center of the wheel, united with the consort, by this very rite the mantra syllables pass from the goddess's mouth into one's own mouth, and in sequence one should make the mantra circle without interruption. This is the wheel recitation. Having set the

mantra syllables in one's own heart, one should contemplate them radiating light rays, with their heads turned upward. This is the cluster recitation. One should understand with the mind that those mantra syllables are being spoken from the mouths of the lord of the maṇḍala and of the maṇḍala deities. This is the pledge recitation. After that, one exhales to the limit of whatever object of focus one wishes, thinking that it goes upward from the navel, and imagines the breath entering inward through the nose. Thus, without focusing below, one recognizes the sound as one wishes; the other, hidden instruction is also of this kind. This is the vajra recitation.

Then, having completed the state of the Lord of the Wrathful Ones by the sequence stated earlier, one emanates the wrathful ones in their proper order and should dispatch them to summon the hosts of obstructors. Having dispatched them, one imagines three cities of liberation upon the three realities, imagining them in this way. From the gathering of the elephant vessel one generates a vajra, and likewise from the earth vessel a bell, and so becomes the holder of vajra and bell. For the benefit of sentient beings, one should bless the torma through the distinctions of the rites and the application of the colors. They are summoned into the city of Vajradhara, and the misleaders are summoned merely by Uṣṇīṣacakravartin above and Sumbharāja below. Having invoked them with the mantras beginning oṃ andi ja ma ja la, with oṃ ākarṣaya jaḥoṃ oṃ padmatraya prabeśaya hūṃ oṃ svasvasthana bandhaya baṃ oṃ vajraghaṇḍaya baśidkuṃ ru hoḥ one summons them, makes them enter, binds them and satisfies them. Having generated the torma as nectar by the rite already stated, one performs the offerings of foot-water, flowers, incense, scent, lamps, the five and the rest, praise, and the presentation of the torma; and with these going before, one sings the songs of the junctures and performs the lotus-turning gesture and the rest.

Then, after the embraces, one forms the binding seal and visualizes the obstructors in the center of the city of liberation. In its central city and on the eastern petal is Indra, thousand-eyed, white and yellow, holding a vajra in his hand, seated on the white Airāvata. On the southern petal is Yama, holding a staff, black, riding a buffalo. On the western petal is Varuṇa, white, with a makara for his mount, holding a night lotus and a lotus. On the northern petal is the yakṣa, yellow, with a horse for his mount, holding a bilva fruit. All of these wear hanging ornaments and jeweled crowns. Yama has a sun seat and the radiance of the sun; the rest have moon seats and the radiance of the

moon. On the petal of Īśāna is the Lord of Bhūtas (Śiva), white, three-eyed, with a crown of matted locks and a bull for his mount, holding a trident and wearing a tiger-skin garment, his body smeared with ash, adorned with all the bone ornaments, with a moon seat and the radiance of the moon. On the petal of fire is Agni, the fire god, with a hanging belly, very stout and short, riding a goat, red, holding a rosary and a ewer, with a crown of matted locks and a garment of bark, with a sun seat and the radiance of the sun. On the petal of the rākṣasa is the rākṣasa, with hair hanging loose, holding a sword and a skull cup, wrathful and frowning, black, on a corpse, with a sun seat and the radiance of the sun. On the petal of the wind is Vāyu, holding a vajra, green, with a jeweled crown, riding a deer, with a moon seat and the radiance of the moon, wearing all the ornaments. At the center is Pṛthivī, the earth goddess, yellow, wearing divine garments and all the ornaments, holding a vase, with a moon seat and the radiance of the moon, and the hungry ghosts dwell surrounding the earth goddess on every side. The five beginning with Indra hold nāga nooses in their left hands, and all of them stand with the left leg extended.

Above, on the eight petals of the lotus resting on the source of phenomena: on the eastern petal is the Moon, white, with a horse for his mount and a white jeweled crown, holding a night lotus and wearing all the ornaments, with a moon seat and the radiance of the moon. On the southern petal is the Sun, red, holding lotuses in both hands, with green and yellow horses for his mount and a jeweled crown, wearing all the ornaments, with his own seat and radiance. On the western petal is Mercury, yellow, riding a rat, with a sun seat and the radiance of the sun, holding an arrow, with a jeweled crown. On the northern petal is Venus, with blue light rays, a sun seat and the radiance of the sun, wearing a jeweled crown and holding a spear. On the petal of Īśāna is Maṅgala (Mars), red, with a sun seat and the radiance of the sun, his hair streaming upward, holding a lotus. On the petal of fire is Jupiter, deep yellow, with a sun seat and the radiance of the sun, wearing a jeweled crown and holding a lamp. On the petal of the rākṣasa is Saturn, black, with reddish-yellow hair, a sun seat and the radiance of the sun, holding a trident.

On the petal of the wind are Rāhu and Ketu, with sun seats and the radiance of the sun, black and smoke-colored respectively: Rāhu, who draws in and devours the wheel of saṃsāra and holds the gesture of invitation, and Ketu, who holds his palms joined. On the hub at its center is Brahmā, four-armed and four-faced, holding a triple staff and the gesture of fearlessness, and

holding a rosary and a ewer in his remaining hands. He is yellow, with a cow for his mount, a moon seat and the radiance of the moon, and he wears the brahmanical thread. He is surrounded on every side by Brahmās, plump, short and with matted locks, and encircled by the gods of the Brahmakāyika heaven, the Brahmapurohita heaven, the Yāma heaven, Akaniṣṭha and the rest.

Below, on the source of phenomena, in the order of the directions, are the nāga Vāsuki, yellow; the nāga Padma, white; the nāga Karkoṭa, red; the nāga Takṣaka, black; the nāga Śaṅkhapāla, yellow; the nāga Mahāpadma, green; the nāga Ananta, pale; and the nāga Kulika, multicolored. These eight wear jeweled crowns, have human faces, wear all the ornaments, and have heads marked with serpent hoods, and they are accompanied by asuras and hell beings. On the hub is the remaining nāga king, with a crown of white jewels, a human face and a serpent hood.

Having thus made them stable, they transform once again. Through the union of Body, Speech and Mind they are gathered and fully perfected, and one should view those dwelling above as having the form of Body, those dwelling in the middle as having the form of Akṣobhya, and those dwelling below as having the form of Speech Vajra. For the sake of all the rites, their hands and faces are again just like one's own. For the other rites, one should apply the pride accordingly: just as one's own form is, so is that of all of them.

After that, one urges them on with the mantra oṃ pravarasakārāya arghaṃ pratīccha svāhā and gives the guest water, and having offered water for the feet at their feet with the seal of flicking the nails, one should invite them to partake with idaṃ baliṃ bhuñja jīgha and the rest, and should also request the task. After that, with the songs of the junctures one recites the mantras of the Blessed One, the Blessed Lady, the wheel of goddesses and the wrathful ones, and, holding vajra and bell, one rings the bell, with the invitation going first, and twirls the vajra. Having recited oṃ akāro mukhaṃ sarvadharmāṇāṃ and the rest, with this, oṃ vajraheruka samayamanubālaya vajraheruka tveno pratiṣṭha dṛḍho me bhava sutoṣyo me bhava supoṣyo me bhava anurakto me bhava sarvasiddhiṃ me prayaccha sarvakarmāsu ca me cittaṃ śreyaḥ kuru hūṃ ha ha ha hoḥ bhagavān sarvatathāgata vajraheruka vajra māme muñca heruko vajrī bhava mahāsamayasatva ā hūṃ phaṭḥ, one should send away those who have been satisfied. Here, this is the mantra of departure: oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. Otherwise it is oṃ vajra muḥ muḥ muḥ.

The syllable oṃ is the aspiration,
the syllable āḥ is satisfaction,
the syllable hūṃ is contentment,
and the three syllables phaṭ are the withdrawal.

The goddesses are valid, the pledge is valid,
and the words they have spoken are supremely valid.
By that truth, may those goddesses
become the cause of my being taken into their care.

Attached equally to existence and to peace, you who have destroyed doubt and conceptual thought,
who see all things as empty, like space,
protectors whose minds swell with the water of compassion, the supreme love,
O goddesses, show me your loving care, show it!

This, which begins with the six limbs and culminates in the reality of the torma, is the samādhi called the Supreme King of Rites.

Arising from that, one imagines a variegated lotus in the center of the source of phenomena, on its petals the eight lords of the eights, and at its heart a seed syllable. From the seed one meditates on the tip of the nāda unfolding, and in order to make the mind stable one should contemplate the subtle extremity. By becoming one with it, the mind becomes stable without doubt, and merely through the mind's stability one should emanate the hosts of tathāgatas and the vast hosts of yoginīs so that they pervade the infinite world systems. From what? From one's own sign there radiates the inconceivable protector, the sovereign whose nature includes the maṇḍala; and one should imagine the sign as merely the size of a large mustard seed. This is the samādhi called the subtle yoga.

Arising from that, if one has also put on the two armors, one should walk about in the yoga of the coemergent Hevajra. With the verse beginning "With the form of the wheel of Akṣobhya," hūṃ on the head becomes the wheel, hrīḥ on the ears the divine earrings, jāṃ on the throat the necklace, aṃ on the arms the two armlets, khaṃ on the hips the girdle itself, and haṃ on the whole body the body of ash; by the great instruction one dons this armor. Likewise there is the armor beginning "In the eyes, Mohavajrā." Here the armor mantra is this: aṃ āṃ iṃ īṃ uṃ ūṃ. By that and by this, the body fully clad by Vajrayoginī and the tathāgatas is the Blessed One: this is the second armor. Having donned the armor by this means, the yogin of the yoga of the coemergent

Hevajra should abide like a lion. Where? Within the house of the three worlds.

And likewise:

This is the celestial palace, not the three realms of existence; these are not living beings, these are the Victors.
I am the lord of the wheel, not a human being; these are not sense objects, not sense faculties, not earth and the rest.
They are the nature of reality, my very self, not form and the rest; those and these are the deities of the maṇḍala.
The manifold is the mind equal to the wheel of the maṇḍala: why then are you deluded?

After that, whatever food substances have been prepared, or whatever the yogin obtains, all of it, as before, one purifies as the feast of tasting nectar, blesses with the three realities, and should then eat.

Having stated the rite of eating, I shall now speak of dwelling and moving about, following the root tantra:

Craving, delusion, attachment and anger,
and frivolous play are to be abandoned.
When sleep and pride are fully abandoned,
practice the conduct without doubt.

Therefore:

Having given the body as a gift,
afterward properly undertake the conduct.
Having discerned the fit and the unfit,
for that reason gifts are not given.

Food, edibles and drink:
eat them just as they are obtained.
From the thought of wanted and unwanted
no grasping is to be made here.

The proper union of the five families
is to be examined as a single family,
so that, through one family and many,
no distinction arises.

At a lone tree or in a charnel ground,
virtuous meditation is taught,

in the house of the mātṛkās at night,
or else at a place where there are no people.

If one wishes to practice the conduct,
it is when a little heat has been attained.
If one wishes to go to accomplishment
and practices, practice with this conduct.

The rest is also clear in the root tantra. "Conduct" means conduct, and it is said of moving about, dwelling, convention, conduct, and also the ultimate, once the great supreme has been fully attained. If one asks what is meant by "great supreme," it is the attainment of a little heat. What does this mean? Because it is still slight, one practices hidden at night in one's own place, until heat has been attained in that way. From what is this known? From the words "how distinctions are not known." Once it has been attained, whether one acts freely without fixed arrangement or does not act is up to oneself.

Then, in another session, one who wishes to sleep should sleep after first practicing the yoga of the joy of cessation, and at the time of rising, being roused by the songs of Pukkasī and the others, one rises and does as before. This sequence continues until one attains the wheel of the maṇḍala. Then:

Without realizing the generation stage,
one does not know the completion;
and without realizing the completion stage,
there is likewise no generation stage.

And likewise:

Relying equally on the two stages,
the Vajra Holder taught the Dharma.

Thus it is within the wheel of the maṇḍala as it has been taught. The one face is the purity of nondual wisdom. The two arms are the purity of emptiness and compassion. The vajra in the right hand makes clear indivisible wisdom. In the left are the skull cup and the khaṭvāṅga: the khaṭvāṅga is the nature of wisdom, and the skull cup makes clear the awakening mind. Likewise, the four arms signify the destruction of the four māras. The one face is the purity of inconceivable wisdom. The vajra in the first right hand makes clear the path of union. The skull cup in the first left hand is filled with the blood of gods and asuras. The words "gods and asuras" mean entities and nonentities. The word

"blood" means having become suchness. The word "filled" means attaining that state. That is the purified human skull. With the remaining hands he embraces Vajravārāhī. Likewise, the six arms are the purity of the six perfections. The three faces make clear Body, Speech and Mind. The bell in the left hand is the purity of emptiness. The trident signifies cutting off the three kinds of ignorance. The vajra in the right hand is the purity of the wisdom of equality. The flaying knife, too, is for cutting off the remaining cognition. With the remaining hands he holds the flaying knife and the skull cup. Such is the arrangement of the two-armed, four-armed and six-armed forms. With legs half crossed, he abides on a sun upon a corpse. The rest is as for the sixteen-armed form, and so too for those of the third.

The summary that the glorious Saroruhapāda taught in brief
I, known as Jālandharipa, have explained at his command:
it is a concise explanation relying on his Dharma.

This concise explanation of the pure stages
was made by the Vajra of Joy.
By it may all beings become the glorious Vajra
and reach the far shore of wisdom.

Here ends the Concise Explanation of the Sādhana of Glorious Hevajra composed by the master Saroruhapāda, called the Pure Vajra Lamp, composed by the accomplished master Śrī Jālandharipāda. It was translated by the translator Nyima Gyaltsen Palsangpo, having heard it from the paṇḍita Mañjuśrī.

Translator's Notes

• The list of summary topics begins with "then," as in the Tibetan, and though called thirty-two it yields thirty-three items if "the supreme" and "the coemergent" are counted separately. In the lemma on the yogin, the Tibetan reads gyi sa ("ground"), evidently a slip for gyis, and is translated accordingly. "Rendering the meaning of the words in another way" (tshig gi don gzhan du byas nas) appears to refer to explaining the tantra's words according to their hidden sense.
• The sentence explaining why the generation of the seat does not call for hūṃ phaṭ is terse and its logic (that "syllable" here means emptiness, and that generation from syllables yields a "mass") is rendered as closely as the Tibetan allows. Rin chen dbang po, marking the head of Padmāntaka's companion figure, is translated "the Lord of Jewels"; it presumably refers to Ratnasambhava, but the name could not be identified with confidence. Nag po chen po in the description of the four wrathful ones of the intermediate directions is taken as a color, "deep black," not the deity Mahākāla. "In the center of the four" is literal; the reference is not stated.
• The kīla spikes "with the heads of wrathful ones" (khro bo'i mgo mdung) and "topped by the form of Amṛtakuṇḍalin" (bdud rtsi 'khyil pa) are interpretive renderings of a compressed

description. The southern charnel ground ('jigs byed thod pa can) and the clouds are translated into English, as their Sanskrit names could not be identified with confidence. The western tree, spelled ke ke lā, is taken as the kaṅkeli (aśoka) tree. The nāga Kulika is described as "wrathful" (khro bo), where a color would be expected; this may be a slip. "The foundation of the earth element" renders dbang chen gyi gzhi, the mahendra (earth) foundation.

• Several birds and instruments are identified only approximately: thi ba and thi ba mo are taken as horned owls male and female; ri skegs as the myna; kṛviḍa (spelled kṛ bi ḍa) is an unidentified drum; pheg rdob pa is taken as clappers. Among the seven ornaments corresponding to the limbs of awakening, phyogs can is rendered "pennants" and mda' yab "parapets," both uncertain. The exegesis of the applications of mindfulness in the last paragraphs is terse and has been rendered closely.

• "Does not hold up" renders mi bzad pa, read as mi bzod pa, "does not withstand [analysis]"; as written it means "terrible, unbearable." In the faculties section the second item (engagement), which corresponds to diligence in the list, is said as written to be "expressed by the word faith"; this may be a scribal slip for diligence, but it is translated as it stands. The sense of "by the word urasa it is expressed otherwise" is unclear.

• "In the Hevajra" renders the bare name Hevajra (dgyes mdzad rdo rje) heading the list of the four gods; it may refer to the root tantra or to the deity trampling them. The fourth māra is given as "the son of the gods, following Brahmā" (lha'i bu rjes su tshangs pa); the last words are unclear, perhaps a slip for rjes su chags pa, "attachment," and are rendered only as "the son of the gods." "The Leader of Wealth" (nor gyi 'dren pa) is translated literally; in the Hevajra scheme this seat is Kubera's, but the form is not a standard rendering. Gaurī's body is spelled Hedu ka in the Tibetan, read as Heruka. The vowel series is said to begin with i as written, where one would expect a. In the explanation of the means of gathering, only generosity and consistency are glossed clearly; the sentence on bliss and joy appears to stand for pleasant speech.

• The lists of the eight liberations and the sixteen emptinesses are given as this text words them, which departs in places from the standard lists. "Because the essence of the nature is reckoned so" renders rang bzhin ngo bo grangs pas, whose sense is uncertain. "From Earth through the Wealth Holder" translates sa and nor 'dzin literally; these are the first and last of the figures held in the left-hand skull cups (in the Hevajra tradition, the earth goddess and Vaiśravaṇa or Dhanada), but the names are not identified with confidence. "Swellings" renders phol.

• "Heroic" renders dbang po as written, read as dpa' bo, the heroic sentiment, which the list of nine requires. For Gaurī the text writes bsad pa, "slain," where the parallel entries for the other goddesses have sad pa, "awaken"; it is read as "awaken." The sense of "the foot of the awakening mind" and of the four wheels "beginning with the emanation wheel" follows the Tibetan closely but is somewhat obscure.

• The sixteen goddesses are given their standard Sanskrit names where the Tibetan is a recognized rendering; "the Mirror Goddess" (me long ma) is translated literally, as its Sanskrit form in this list is not certain. The Tibetan writes glu med, "without song," for the seventh, read as glu ma, Gītā. The four arising songs are given as the commentary paraphrases them, not as the root verses. "Bones, marrow" renders rus pa dang rkang pa, taking rkang as marrow.

• Several syllables are given as written although they repeat (aṃ for consciousness, ṛṃ and ḷṃ twice, oṃ three times). In the ninth-chapter verse, "in touch, Bhūcarī" follows the evident reading reg la sa spyod ma for the written reg las spyod ma. The lotus petal count "sixty-four, eight, sixteen" reads the written brgyad cu drug as brgyad bcu drug, eight and sixteen; taken literally it would be "eighty-six," which does not fit the four lotuses. The question about the outer consort is construed as "if she is not excellent, one should not do it."

• "Mind," "the Eternal One" and "the Jewel Lord" are the family lords sealing the goddesses,

presumably Akṣobhya, Vairocana and Ratnasambhava. The four "realizations" (of all aspects, peak, gradual, and so on) borrow the names of the stages of realization of the Abhisamayālaṃkāra. Gzugs rdo rje ma is rendered Rūpavajrā, the goddess of visible form.
• The commentary explains the root phrase "a mass of light rays" by taking the word for "mass" (Tibetan phung po) in its other sense of "aggregate," which is why the gloss turns to the five aggregates. In the verse, "supreme First One" reads dang pa as dang po; it may instead mean "clear, radiant." In the sentence on Khecarī, Bhūcarī and Nairātmyā, the word gzhan ("other") before "appearance" makes little sense and has been left untranslated; the three terms are the standard appearance, increase and attainment of appearance. The passage on withdrawal at the time of sleep is terse and its sense is uncertain.
• "Following the Yoginīsaṃcāra" takes rnal 'byor ma'i kun tu spyod pa as the title of that tantra; it could instead mean "through the yoginī's conduct." Several evident copyists' slips are translated by their plain readings: mgon po ("protector") as mgo bo, "heads"; sgra ("sound") as skra, "hair"; lag pa ("hand") as lhag pa, Mercury; and pa ba sangs as pa sangs, Venus. The "elephant vessel" from which the vajra is generated is literal and its sense is uncertain. The "songs of the junctures" (mtshams kyi glu) is a tentative rendering.
• Brahmā's mount is given as ba, "cow"; this may be a slip for ngang ba, "swan," his usual mount. "In the order of the directions" renders phyogs bral, whose exact sense is unclear. "In the center of the source of phenomena" renders chos kyi dbus, taken as short for the dharmodaya; it could also be read "in the center of the Dharma."
• "The Vajra of Joy" (dga' ba'i rdo rje), named in the closing verse as the maker of the explanation, may be another name of the author, perhaps Ānandavajra, or an allusion to Hevajra; it is translated literally because it cannot be identified with confidence. In the feast passage, chogs is read as tshogs, "feast." The verses on conduct are from the Hevajra Tantra.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.